the other. He is wrong, the dispute is not between one political opinion and another, but between dictatorship and democracy. The fact that he did not react to Barak's first statement and waited for several days after the second spate of declarations shows, in my opinion, that he has been compelled to say what he said.

The turmoil of the last few weeks has compelled me to rethink some basic assumptions and to go back to much earlier times. My father, the least interested in Zionism that anyone could be, wrote to a friend in London, shortly after we fled from Prague and arrived in Paris:

> Although the news coming from Palestine is not very favorable … everybody agrees that one has the feeling of being at home there, as a free citizen. We can all appreciate what that means today. I don't want to begin the same comedy all over again in another state or in another country and would rather remain a *schnorrer* all my life, or wage war on the Arabs. But it will be a year at best before our turn for an immigration certificate comes up, and for people like us there is no way to decide things so far ahead.

My parents' turn for immigration certificates never came. They were murdered in Auschwitz.

Whatever other moral justifications there may be for Zionism —and there are—the only incontrovertible one, although *a posteriori*, of the immigration to Palestine up to 1945, is that without anybody having foreseen it or having been able to foresee it, this immigration not only was a last refuge for some, but also saved the lives of about half a million European Jews. The children of those immigrants were born in Palestine and, later, in Israel; the evolution thereafter was what it was.

Former attorney general Mandelblit calls for the abandonment of the judicial overhaul, which he named a "judicial horror" (*toeva hakikatit*).

Knesset members from Torah Judaism complain that Netanyahu is not fulfilling his promises and that budget appropriations they should have received have not been paid. Ben-Gvir complains about exclusion from important meetings of the Security Cabinet and, generally speaking, about